Patrick A. Marais

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SKILLS & EXPERTISE

- Information management
- Strategic management
- Financial management
- Conflict management
- Training
- Public Service
- Departmental leadership
- Stakeholder management
- Cyber Security
- Community Engagement
- Risk mitigation
- Governance
- Project management
- Investigations
- Cyber Resilience

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Commerce (Honours)	Metro University A	1999
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Certificate in Terrorism Studies	International University B	2012
National Certificate: Crime Resolving	Training Institute C	2012
Basic Ambulance Assistant	National First Aid League	2008
Computer Forensics	National Research Council	2006
Investigators Course	National Detective Academy	2003
Advanced Certificate: Criminal Investigations	Technikon National	2003

IT CERTIFICATIONS, LICENCES & COURSES

CERTIFICATIONS COMPLETED

Security+	CompTIA	2024
Certified in Cyber Security	$(ISC)^2$	2023

COURSES COMPLETED

Human Factors in AI-driven Cybersecurity	Training Provider X	2026
Space Cybersecurity: Why it Matters	Training Provider X	2026
Cybercrime	International Agency Y	2026
SOC Core Skills	Training Provider X	2026
Linux100: Fundamentals	Security Academy Z	2025
The Definitive GRC Analyst Masterclass	Security Academy Z	2025
Applying AI Principles	Online Learning Platform	2025
Introduction to Responsible AI	Online Learning Platform	2025

Introduction to Large Language Models	Online Learning Platform	2025
Introduction to Generative AI	Online Learning Platform	2025
Tools of the Trade: Linux and SQL	Online Learning Platform	2024
Ethics in the Age of Generative AI	Online Learning Platform	2024
What is Generative AI	Online Learning Platform	2024
Get started with AI on Cloud	Cloud Provider	2024
Networks and Network Security	Online Learning Platform	2024
Manage Security Risks	Online Learning Platform	2024
Introduction to Networking	Immersive Learning Lab	2024
Introduction to Incident Response	Immersive Learning Lab	2024
Cyber Fundamentals	Immersive Learning Lab	2024
Data Privacy	Immersive Learning Lab	2024
Foundations of Cyber Security	Online Learning Platform	2024
Ethics and Law	Immersive Learning Lab	2024
Technical Support Fundamentals	Online Learning Platform	2024
Security Fundamentals	IT Training Provider	2024
Network Fundamentals	IT Training Provider	2024
IT Fundamentals	IT Training Provider	2024
Leveraging the Intelligence Cycle	$(ISC)^2$	2023
Introduction to the NIST Cyber Security Framework	$(ISC)^2$	2023
Introduction to Artificial Intelligence	$(ISC)^2$	2023
Cloud Basics	$(ISC)^2$	2023
A Practical Guide to Cloud Computing	Security Council	2023
Introduction to Computer Networks for Non-Techies	Online Course Platform	2023
Cybersecurity Fundamentals	Tech Skills Platform	2023

COURSES

FICA Awareness	2023
Comprehensive Primary Health Care II (NQF5)	2018
Psychology in Society (NQF5)	2018
Dealing with Child Sensitive Cases	2018
Health Counselling and Testing	2017
Comprehensive Primary Health Care I (NQF5)	2016
Anti-Corruption Issues in the Public Sector	2013
The Prevalence, Impact, Complexity and Prevention of Torture	2013
Basic Psychology (NQF5)	2012
International Advanced Security in the Field	2011
Money Laundering and Terrorism Funding	2007
Course in Counterfeit Currency	2006

Certificate in Tender Management	2006
Certificate in Project Management	2005
Surveillance Course	2004
Crime Scene Investigations	2004
Managing Complex Investigative Projects	2003
Directorate Foundation Training (16-week)	2003
Managing and Leading People (NQF8)	2002
Marketing Management (NQF8)	2002
Financial and Management Accounting (NQF8)	2002

EMPLOYMENT HISTORY

Business Consultant Feb 2025 – Present
Self-Employed

- Conduct cyber risk and compliance assessments using NIST standards
- Develop comprehensive risk mitigation strategies

Regional Surveillance Manager Apr 2024 – Jan 2025
National Security Solutions Group

- Manage regional team and sub-contractors
- Ownership of the regional surveillance (CCTV) strategy
- Initiate and manage all community projects
- Liaise with the business on rollout of new products and projects
- Align the region with new products and solutions in surveillance
- Train and support sales teams on new and existing products
- Provide weekly reports to management and clients
- Responsible for onboarding products into regional control rooms
- Manage interdependencies of multiple control rooms and align SOPs
- Manage regional and local control rooms operationally
- Analyse engagement data and plan digital campaigns
- Ensure local inventory aligns with new project requirements
- Project manage new surveillance projects to meet timelines

Achievements: Successfully established and grew a new regional division; completed site compliance audits across all regional sites.

Branch Manager, Coastal Region May 2022 – March 2024
National Security Solutions Group

- Establish and manage armed response branch, including officers, sales representatives and technicians
- Manage budget, stretch budget and Profit & Loss, including forecasting
- Champion development of a customer-focused quality improvement culture
- Promote advanced technological solutions to community security
- Manage branch fleet
- Maintain health and safety policies and procedures
- Drive marketing activations within the branch
- Manage staff training needs and development
- Manage profitability

Achievements: Established the best performing new branch in the region; redesigned the reporting system, now used as regional best practice.

Programme and Operations Manager August 2017 – December 2019
Community Health Initiatives (Ad Hoc Contracts and Projects)

- Programme development and implementation, focusing on family health and wellness
- Campaign management – Obesity Education Campaign Manager, May 2019 – Dec 2019
- Managed team of health educators (training, logistics, operational management)
- Educational awareness campaigns involving GPs, dieticians and diabetes specialists
- Liaised with government health department and NPOs in planning health promotion campaigns
- Monitoring and evaluation during all phases of programme development
- Developmental research and environmental scans
- Project planning and workshop facilitation

Community Development Manager January 2019 – December 2021
National Security Solutions Group

- Develop technological and other security solutions in the community
- Establish and manage relationships with community policing forums, police services, and neighbourhood watches
- Identify and track crime trends and address community solutions
- Liaise with community support manager for effective communication
- Investigate high level complaints, incidents and operational matters
- Monitor and manage security sector activity
- Analyse suburb-specific data to facilitate effective regional management
- Administration, reports, statistics and site assessments
- Inculcate a strong safety-first and EHS standards focus
- Actively work towards enhancing employee engagement

Achievements: Decreased attrition to record low levels; improved community relations; turned around company image and local brand perception; managed strategic relationships with key stakeholders; established strong networking skills in the market.

Operations Manager August 2017 – October 2018
Metro Security Services

- Client relationship management
- Ensure compliance and adherence to contractual agreements with clients
- Comprehensive risk and threat assessments at various sites
- Needs analysis and problem-solving at client locations
- Incident management
- Asset management
- Policy and regulation development
- Responsible for training team members on policies and procedures

Achievements: Established several key stakeholder sites; enhanced business processes for effective management.

Forensic and Security Manager June 2015 – July 2017
National Development Finance Corporation

- Conduct security investigations into all areas of concern

- Manage physical security and safety at branches nationwide (external guarding contractor, approx. 40 guards)
- Identify high loss potential areas and implement mitigating measures
- Work with technical and logistical teams to improve physical security
- Ensure adherence to security processes and develop relevant policies
- Research, procure and implement CCTV technology
- Conduct fraud and theft training interventions
- Ensure safety of over 700 employees and assets nationwide
- Implement safety and security measures during special events
- Manage large safety and security projects for new construction
- Manage contracts with external service providers
- Conduct training interventions in First Aid and Fire Fighting

Achievements: Established a national security function including 300+ CCTV cameras, guarding, and risk systems; designed and implemented contingency planning; concluded several investigations successfully; technology cost optimisation; headed the Occupational Health and Safety Committee; represented the company on industry forums.

Independent Lecturer in Environmental Investigations October 2013 – Feb 2015
National Distance Learning University

- Researched, developed and compiled content for a specialised investigations programme
- Presented study material to students including practical and theoretical application
- Conducted formative and summative assessments of students

Principal Investigator March 2012 – August 2013
Independent Police Oversight Body

- Criminal investigations: murder, theft, corruption, fraud
- Managed team of senior investigators: case allocation, docket inspection, guidance and training
- Compiled and presented statistical reports at senior management meetings
- Crime scene management: took over crime scenes from police when relevant
- Managed data systems and trained staff
- Provided recommendations to prosecutorial and provincial authorities
- Implemented compliance regulations and standards

Achievements: Supported overhaul of the database system and information retrieval framework; launched the case backlog project.

Security Associate (fixed-term contract) June 2011 – August 2011
International Population Agency

- Responsible for security plans and measures in the regional office
- Managed relevant security technology
- Maintained liaison with regional offices and international safety department
- Ensured compliance with minimum operational security standards
- Ensured business continuity during emergency and disaster situations
- Ensured effective functioning of emergency communication and warden systems
- Managed procurement of related services and goods
- Ensured effective delivery of the security function in the regional office

- Supported training courses, briefings and security workshops

Achievements: Implemented the warden system for the greater metropolitan region.

Specialised Projects Consultant (fixed-term contract) April 2008 – December 2010
Regional Advisory Associates

- Client liaison, market research, development of proposals, project management

Special Investigator April 2003 – March 2008
National Prosecuting Authority – Special Investigations Directorate

- Cyber crime first responder and member of the Behavioural Science Unit
- Investigated crimes of national priority (organised crime, narcotics, endangered species, serious economic offences, crimes against the state)
- Operational management including planning, execution and debriefing of high-risk tactical operations
- Managed team of operators during surveillance and undercover operations
- Performed witness and VIP protection duties
- Undertook comprehensive risk and threat assessments
- Operational reporting and logistics including procurement and asset management
- Trained members in the use of firearms, tactical batons and specialised equipment

Achievements: Represented the organisation on national and international forums, including cyber forensic interagency cooperation networks; developed Standard Operating Procedure documents for firearms and operational equipment; managed procurement of multi-million-value specialised law enforcement equipment.